



Formal Logic (SM234614)

SAT in Z3



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Example of a SAT Formula



Consider the formula

$$\varphi = (x_1 \vee x_2) \wedge (\neg x_1 \vee x_3) \wedge (\neg x_2 \vee \neg x_3).$$

- ▶ Variables: x_1, x_2, x_3
- ▶ Operators: $\wedge, \vee, \neg$
- ▶ Goal: find a truth assignment that makes all clauses true



SAT can be viewed as a constraint satisfaction problem.

$$(x_1 \vee x_2) = \text{True}$$

$$(\neg x_1 \vee x_3) = \text{True}$$

$$(\neg x_2 \vee \neg x_3) = \text{True}$$

Satisfying Assignment

A solution is an assignment of Boolean values satisfying all constraints simultaneously.



What is Z3?



Z3 is an SMT solver developed by Microsoft Research.

- ▶ SAT solver: handles Boolean formulas
- ▶ SMT solver: extends SAT with theories such as integers, arrays, bit-vectors, etc.
- ▶ Can be used from Python
- ▶ Suitable for modeling logical and mathematical constraints



Using Z3 in Google Colab



In Google Colab, install Z3 using:

```
!pip install z3-solver
```

Then import Z3:

```
from z3 import *
```



We define Boolean variables using Bool.

```
from z3 import *  
  
x1 = Bool('x1')  
x2 = Bool('x2')  
x3 = Bool('x3')
```

These variables can take values:

$$x_i \in \{\text{True}, \text{False}\}.$$



The formula

$$(x_1 \vee x_2) \wedge (\neg x_1 \vee x_3) \wedge (\neg x_2 \vee \neg x_3)$$

can be written in Z3 as:

```
# Boolean variables
x1 = Bool('x1')
x2 = Bool('x2')
x3 = Bool('x3')

# SAT formula
phi = And(
    Or(x1, x2),
    Or(Not(x1), x3),
    Or(Not(x2), Not(x3))
)
```



Solving the Formula



We create a solver and add the formula.

```
# Create solver  
s = Solver()  
  
# Add formula  
s.add(phi)  
  
# Check satisfiability  
print(s.check())
```

Output

```
sat
```




Getting a Model



If the formula is satisfiable, Z3 can return one satisfying assignment.

```
if s.check() == sat:  
    print(s.model())
```

Example output:

```
[x1 = False, x2 = True, x3 = False]
```

So one solution is

$$x_1 = \text{False}, \quad x_2 = \text{True}, \quad x_3 = \text{False}.$$



Checking the Assignment



For

$$x_1 = \text{False}, \quad x_2 = \text{True}, \quad x_3 = \text{False},$$

we check each clause:

$$(x_1 \vee x_2) = (\text{False} \vee \text{True}) = \text{True}$$

$$(\neg x_1 \vee x_3) = (\text{True} \vee \text{False}) = \text{True}$$

$$(\neg x_2 \vee \neg x_3) = (\text{False} \vee \text{True}) = \text{True}$$

Therefore,

$$\varphi = \text{True}.$$



An Unsatisfiable Example



Consider the formula

$$\psi = x_1 \wedge \neg x_1.$$

In Z3:

```
x1 = Bool('x1')
psi = And(x1, Not(x1))
s = Solver()
s.add(psi)

print(s.check())
```

The output is:

```
unsat
```



SAT vs UNSAT



Output	Meaning
sat	A satisfying assignment exists
unsat	No satisfying assignment exists
unknown	Z3 cannot determine the answer



Template for Solving SAT with Z3



```
from z3 import *

# Define variables
x1 = Bool('x1')
x2 = Bool('x2')

# Define formula
phi = And(
    Or(x1, x2),
    Or(Not(x1), x2)
)

# Create solver
s = Solver()
s.add(phi)

# Check satisfiability
if s.check() == sat:
    print("SAT")
    print(s.model())
else:
    print("UNSAT")
```



Output:

```
SAT  
[x1 = False, x2 = True]
```



Boolean Operations in Z3



In SAT problems, Boolean formulas are constructed using logical operations.

Operation	Mathematical Notation	Z3 Syntax
Negation	$\neg x$	Not(x)
Conjunction	$x \wedge y$	And(x, y)
Disjunction	$x \vee y$	Or(x, y)
Implication	$x \Rightarrow y$	Implies(x, y)
Equivalence	$x \Leftrightarrow y$	<code>x == y</code>
Exclusive OR	$x \oplus y$	Xor(x, y)



Boolean Operations in Z3



```
from z3 import *

x = Bool('x')
y = Bool('y')
z = Bool('z')

phi = And(
    Or(x, y),           # x OR y
    Implies(x, z),      # if x then z
    Not(And(y, z))      # NOT (y AND z)
)

s = Solver()
s.add(phi)

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```




Boolean Operations in Z3



The output is:

```
sat  
[x = True, y = False, z = True]
```

Therefore, one satisfying assignment is

$$x = \text{True}, \quad y = \text{False}, \quad z = \text{True}.$$



In Z3 Python, we can write constraints more compactly using shortcuts.

Shortcut	Meaning
<code>Bools('x y z')</code>	create several Boolean variables
<code>Ints('x y z')</code>	create several integer variables
<code>And(L)</code>	conjunction of all formulas in list L
<code>And(*L)</code>	unpack list L as arguments of <code>And</code>
<code>Or(L)</code>	disjunction of all formulas in list L
<code>Or(*L)</code>	unpack list L as arguments of <code>Or</code>



Instead of writing variables one by one:

```
x1 = Bool( 'x1' )  
x2 = Bool( 'x2' )  
x3 = Bool( 'x3' )
```



Instead of writing variables one by one:

```
x1 = Bool('x1')  
x2 = Bool('x2')  
x3 = Bool('x3')
```

we can use:

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
```



Instead of writing variables one by one:

```
x1 = Bool('x1')  
x2 = Bool('x2')  
x3 = Bool('x3')
```

we can use:

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
```

For integer variables:

```
a, b, c = Ints('a b c')
```



Suppose we have a list of constraints:

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')  
  
L = [  
    Or(x1, x2),  
    Implies(x1, x3),  
    Not(And(x2, x3))  
]
```



Suppose we have a list of constraints:

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')  
  
L = [  
    Or(x1, x2),  
    Implies(x1, x3),  
    Not(And(x2, x3))  
]
```

Then we can add all constraints at once:

```
s = Solver()  
  
s.add(And(L))
```



Suppose we have a list of constraints:

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L = [  
    Or(x1, x2),  
    Implies(x1, x3),  
    Not(And(x2, x3))  
]
```

Then we can add all constraints at once:

```
s = Solver()  
  
s.add(And(L))
```

This means:

```
And(L[0], L[1], L[2])
```




In Python, `*L` means unpack the list L .

So if

```
L = [A, B, C]
```

then

```
And(*L)
```

is the same as

```
And(A, B, C)
```

Example:

```
s.add(And(*L))
```

This is especially useful when constraints are generated automatically.



We can generate Boolean variables using a list comprehension.

```
x = [Bool(f'x{i}') for i in range(1, 6)]
```



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```
x = [Bool(f'x{i}') for i in range(1, 6)]
```

This creates:

$$x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5.$$



We can generate Boolean variables using a list comprehension.

```
x = [Bool(f'x{i}') for i in range(1, 6)]
```

This creates:

$$x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5.$$

Now suppose all variables must be true:

```
constraints = [x[i] for i in range(5)]  
s = Solver()  
s.add(And(*constraints))  
  
print(s)  
print(s.check())  
print(s.model())
```



We can generate Boolean variables using a list comprehension.

```
x = [Bool(f'x{i}') for i in range(1, 6)]
```

This creates:

$$x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5.$$

Now suppose all variables must be true:

```
constraints = [x[i] for i in range(5)]
s = Solver()
s.add(And(*constraints))

print(s)
print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

The output is

```
[And(x1, x2, x3, x4, x5)]
sat
[x1 = True, x2 = True, x3 = True, x4 = True, x5 = True]
```



Example: At Least One Variable is True



Let

$$x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5$$

be Boolean variables.

```
x = [Bool(f'x{i}') for i in range(1, 6)]  
s = Solver()  
  
# At least one variable is True  
s.add(Or(*x))  
  
print(s.check())  
print(s.model())
```

The command

```
Or(*x)
```

means

$$x_1 \vee x_2 \vee x_3 \vee x_4 \vee x_5.$$



Z3 provides several useful commands for modeling logical and combinatorial problems.

Command	Purpose
PbEq	exactly k Boolean variables are true
PbLe	at most k Boolean variables are true
PbGe	at least k Boolean variables are true
If	if-then-else expression
Sum	sum of arithmetic expressions
Distinct	all values are different



PbEq is useful for modeling “exactly k ” constraints.

$\text{PbEq}([(x_1, 1), (x_2, 1), (x_3, 1)], 1)$ means $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 = 1$.

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
s = Solver()

# Exactly one variable is True
s.add(PbEq([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 1))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```




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x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
s = Solver()

# Exactly one variable is True
s.add(PbEq([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 1))

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print(s.model())
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PbEq is useful for modeling “exactly k ” constraints.

$\text{PbEq}([(x_1, 1), (x_2, 1), (x_3, 1)], 1)$ means $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 = 1$.

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
s = Solver()

# Exactly one variable is True
s.add(PbEq([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 1))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

Possible output:

```
sat
[x1 = True, x2 = False, x3 = False]
```



PbLe means “at most”, while PbGe means “at least”.

$\text{PbLe}([(x_1, 1), (x_2, 1), (x_3, 1)], 2)$ means $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \leq 2$.



PbLe means “at most”, while PbGe means “at least”.

$\text{PbLe}([(x_1, 1), (x_2, 1), (x_3, 1)], 2)$ means $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \leq 2$.

```
x1, x2, x3 = Booleans('x1 x2 x3')
s = Solver()

# At most two variables are True
s.add(PbLe([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 2))

# At least one variable is True
s.add(PbGe([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 1))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```



PbLe means “at most”, while PbGe means “at least”.

$\text{PbLe}([(x_1, 1), (x_2, 1), (x_3, 1)], 2)$ means $x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \leq 2$.

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
s = Solver()

# At most two variables are True
s.add(PbLe([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 2))

# At least one variable is True
s.add(PbGe([(x1,1), (x2,1), (x3,1)], 1))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

Possible output:

```
sat
[x1 = True, x2 = True, x3 = False]
```



If-Then-Else Expression: If



In Z3, If works like an if-then-else expression.

$$\text{If}(p, a, b) = \begin{cases} a, & \text{if } p \text{ is true,} \\ b, & \text{if } p \text{ is false.} \end{cases}$$



If-Then-Else Expression: If



In Z3, If works like an if-then-else expression.

$$\text{If}(p, a, b) = \begin{cases} a, & \text{if } p \text{ is true,} \\ b, & \text{if } p \text{ is false.} \end{cases}$$

```
x = Int('x')
y = Int('y')
s = Solver()

# y = 10 if x is positive, otherwise y = 0
s.add(y == If(x > 0, 10, 0))
s.add(x == 3)

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```



If-Then-Else Expression: If



In Z3, If works like an if-then-else expression.

$$\text{If}(p, a, b) = \begin{cases} a, & \text{if } p \text{ is true,} \\ b, & \text{if } p \text{ is false.} \end{cases}$$

```
x = Int('x')
y = Int('y')
s = Solver()

# y = 10 if x is positive, otherwise y = 0
s.add(y == If(x > 0, 10, 0))
s.add(x == 3)

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

Output:

```
sat
[x = 3, y = 10]
```




The command If can also return a Boolean expression.

$$\text{If}(p, q, r) = \begin{cases} q, & \text{if } p = \text{True}, \\ r, & \text{if } p = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$



The command `If` can also return a Boolean expression.

$$\text{If}(p, q, r) = \begin{cases} q, & \text{if } p = \text{True}, \\ r, & \text{if } p = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$

```
from z3 import *

p, q, r = Bools('p q r')
s = Solver()

# If p is True, then q must be True.
# If p is False, then r must be True.
s.add(If(p, q, r))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```



The command `If` can also return a Boolean expression.

$$\text{If}(p, q, r) = \begin{cases} q, & \text{if } p = \text{True}, \\ r, & \text{if } p = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$

```
from z3 import *

p, q, r = Bools('p q r')
s = Solver()

# If p is True, then q must be True.
# If p is False, then r must be True.
s.add(If(p, q, r))

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

Output:

```
sat
[p = True, q = True]
```



Using If to Count True Variables



We can use If to convert Boolean values into integers.

$$\text{If}(x, 1, 0) = \begin{cases} 1, & x = \text{True}, \\ 0, & x = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$



We can use If to convert Boolean values into integers.

$$\text{If}(x, 1, 0) = \begin{cases} 1, & x = \text{True}, \\ 0, & x = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
count_true = Sum(
    If(x1, 1, 0),
    If(x2, 1, 0),
    If(x3, 1, 0)
)
s = Solver()

# Exactly two variables are True
s.add(count_true == 2)
print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```



Using If to Count True Variables



We can use If to convert Boolean values into integers.

$$\text{If}(x, 1, 0) = \begin{cases} 1, & x = \text{True}, \\ 0, & x = \text{False}. \end{cases}$$

```
x1, x2, x3 = Bools('x1 x2 x3')
count_true = Sum(
    If(x1, 1, 0),
    If(x2, 1, 0),
    If(x3, 1, 0)
)
s = Solver()

# Exactly two variables are True
s.add(count_true == 2)
print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```

Possible output:

```
sat
[x1 = True, x2 = True, x3 = False]
```



The command `Distinct` means that all variables must have different values. For Boolean variables, there are only two possible values:

True and False.

Therefore, at most two Boolean variables can be pairwise distinct.

```
from z3 import *  
  
x, y = Bools('x y')  
s = Solver()  
  
# x and y must have different truth values  
s.add(Distinct(x, y))  
  
print(s.check())  
print(s.model())
```

Possible output:

```
sat  
[x = False, y = True]
```



If we use Distinct for three Boolean variables, the problem becomes impossible.

```
from z3 import *  
  
x, y, z = Bools('x y z')  
s = Solver()  
  
# Impossible: only True and False are available  
s.add(Distinct(x, y, z))  
print(s.check())
```

Output:

```
unsat
```

Important Observation

For Boolean variables, $\text{Distinct}(x, y, z)$ is unsatisfiable because three variables cannot all be different when there are only two truth values.



Why Use Z3 for SAT Problems?



- ▶ We can translate logical problems into constraints.
- ▶ Z3 automatically searches for satisfying assignments.
- ▶ It is useful for puzzles, scheduling, verification, and combinatorial problems.
- ▶ Google Colab makes it easy to run Python and Z3 without local installation.



Solving the Festival Planning Problem



A university is organizing a *one-day innovation festival*. To run the event, the committee must choose exactly one venue, one keynote speaker, and one workshop theme from the following options:

- (i) Venue: Main Hall (v_1), Outdoor Plaza (v_2), and Auditorium (v_3)
- (ii) Keynote Speaker: Entrepreneur (s_1), Scientist (s_2), and Government Official (s_3)
- (iii) Workshop Theme: Artificial Intelligence (w_1), Sustainability (w_2), and Cybersecurity (w_3)

However, the committee faces the following constraints:

- (i) If the event is held in the Outdoor Plaza, then the Government Official cannot be invited.
 - (ii) The festival must feature either the Scientist or the Cybersecurity workshop.
 - (iii) If the workshop theme is Sustainability, then it cannot be held in the Main Hall.
 - (iv) The Entrepreneur cannot be paired with the Artificial Intelligence workshop.
 - (v) If the event is held in the Auditorium, then the workshop must be Artificial Intelligence or Cybersecurity.
-
- (a) Express each constraint as a clause using the variables above.
 - (b) Determine whether the planning problem is satisfiable. If it is, give one satisfying assignment for all variables.



Solving the Festival Planning Problem



```
from z3 import *
# Variables
v1, v2, v3 = Bools('v1 v2 v3')      # venues
s1, s2, s3 = Bools('s1 s2 s3')      # speakers
w1, w2, w3 = Bools('w1 w2 w3')      # workshops

s = Solver()

# Exactly one venue, one speaker, one workshop
s.add(PbEq([(v1,1), (v2,1), (v3,1)], 1))
s.add(PbEq([(s1,1), (s2,1), (s3,1)], 1))
s.add(PbEq([(w1,1), (w2,1), (w3,1)], 1))

# Constraints
s.add(Implies(v2, Not(s3)))           # Outdoor Plaza -> not Govt Official
s.add(Or(s2, w3))                     # Scientist or Cybersecurity
s.add(Implies(w2, Not(v1)))           # Sustainability -> not Main Hall
s.add(Not(And(s1, w1)))               # not(Entrepreneur and AI)
s.add(Implies(v3, Or(w1, w3)))        # Auditorium -> AI or Cybersecurity

print(s.check())
print(s.model())
```



One possible output is:

```
sat
[v1 = False,
 v2 = False,
 v3 = True,
 s1 = False,
 s2 = True,
 s3 = False,
 w1 = True,
 w2 = False,
 w3 = False]
```

Hence one satisfying assignment is:

$$v_3 = \text{True}, \quad s_2 = \text{True}, \quad w_1 = \text{True}.$$

Conclusion

The planning problem is satisfiable. One valid plan is:

Auditorium Scientist Artificial Intelligence.